

Sidewalk Stories LA

Full Grant Proposal Template

This template is designed to be adapted for any foundation, arts commission, or corporate funder. Fill in the bracketed sections with funder-specific language and requirements.

Section 1: Executive Summary (1 page)

Organization: Sidewalk Stories LA, a California nonprofit public benefit corporation **Mission:** Improve public safety and youth civic engagement by repairing damaged sidewalks and transforming them into community-built mosaic art. **Amount Requested:** \$[amount] **Project Period:** [start date] to [end date] **Geographic Focus:** Fairfax / Mid-City West neighborhood, Los Angeles, CA **Primary Contact:** Trevor Damyan, Founder

In one paragraph: Sidewalk Stories LA repairs broken and hazardous sidewalk panels and transforms each one into a small public mosaic, designed and built by neighborhood kids working alongside a professional teaching artist and a licensed concrete crew. Our pilot program will complete 10 panels in Year 1, engage 60 to 100 youth participants, and create a repeatable, neighborhood-based model for civic repair and public art creation.

Section 2: Statement of Need (1 to 2 pages)

The Problem:

Thousands of miles of damaged sidewalks across Los Angeles create daily hazards for seniors, people with mobility challenges, and families with strollers. The City of Los Angeles estimates the repair backlog is measured in years, not months. Responsibility for repair is often unclear between property owners and the city, which means many damaged panels go unaddressed for years.

A single lifted sidewalk panel is more than an inconvenience. For a senior with a walker, it is a fall risk. For a person in a wheelchair, it is a barrier. For a parent with a stroller, it forces a detour into the street.

The Data:

- The City of LA estimates thousands of miles of damaged sidewalks across the city.
- A single panel repair can cost a homeowner \$1,500 or more, which means many simply wait.
- The Safe Sidewalks LA rebate program exists but uptake is limited by awareness and process complexity.

Why This Neighborhood:

The Fairfax / Mid-City West area has visible sidewalk damage, active community engagement, and a property owner willing to partner on the first panel. It is a neighborhood where a small, visible project can build momentum quickly.

Section 3: Project Description (2 to 3 pages)

Overview:

Sidewalk Stories LA operates on a simple, repeatable process:

1. **Report:** Residents photograph damaged sidewalk panels through our mobile app, automatically capturing geolocation.
2. **Vote:** The community votes on which damaged panels matter most. The top-voted panel wins each month.
3. **Repair:** A licensed concrete crew removes the damaged panel, preps the base, and pours new concrete.
4. **Create:** A teaching artist leads neighborhood kids in designing and building a mosaic on the fresh surface.
5. **Celebrate:** We document the before and after, celebrate the young artists, and move to the next panel.

What Makes This Different:

We do not just fix sidewalks. We turn the repair process into a public art and youth education moment. Every panel becomes a story the neighborhood tells together. Unlike traditional public art grants that fund a single installation, Sidewalk Stories LA creates a repeatable, neighborhood-based model with quick, visible outcomes.

Youth Engagement:

Each panel engages 6 to 10 neighborhood kids across two weekends. The first weekend is design: sketching patterns, choosing colors, learning mosaic techniques. The second weekend is installation: cutting tile, setting grout, sealing the surface. Kids gain skills in design, teamwork, and public collaboration. They also build a direct connection to civic life at an early age.

Teaching Artist Role:

Our teaching artist guides all youth sessions, manages materials, and ensures the finished mosaic is weather-resistant and durable. The artist is paid a \$400 stipend per panel.

Section 4: Goals and Objectives (1 page)

Goal 1: Public Safety - Objective: Repair 10 hazardous sidewalk panels in Year 1 - Metric: Number of panels completed; before/after hazard assessment

Goal 2: Youth Engagement - Objective: Engage 60 to 100 neighborhood youth in public art creation - Metric: Youth participants per panel; retention rate; post-program survey

Goal 3: Community Participation - Objective: Generate 200+ resident submissions and 1,000+ community votes via the app - Metric: App submissions; votes cast; community event attendance

Goal 4: Financial Sustainability - Objective: Close \$25,250 in Year 1 revenue from grants, sponsors, and donations - Metric: Revenue by source; cost per panel; cash flow position

Section 5: Budget (1 to 2 pages)

Total Project Cost: \$38,700

Category	Amount	Description
Concrete Repair (10 panels)	\$9,000	Licensed crew: removal, base prep, pour
Mosaic Materials (10 panels)	\$10,000	Tile, grout, sealant, safety gear
Teaching Artist Stipends	\$4,000	\$400 per panel

Category	Amount	Description
City Permits	\$4,000	Right-of-way work permits
Subtotal: Program Costs	\$27,000	\$2,700 per panel
Bookkeeping & Admin	\$3,600	\$300/month
Insurance	\$3,000	\$250/month
App Hosting	\$2,400	\$200/month
Marketing & Social	\$1,200	\$100/month
Subtotal: Operating Costs	\$10,200	
Startup Costs	\$1,500	501(c)(3) filing, branding, website
Total Year 1 Budget	\$38,700	

Amount Requested from This Funder: \$[amount]

Other Funding Sources: - Individual donations: \$6,000 - Corporate sponsorships (5 panels at \$750 each): \$3,750 - Other grants: \$[pending]

Section 6: Evaluation Plan (1 page)

Outputs (what we will produce): - 10 repaired sidewalk panels with mosaic art - 60 to 100 youth participants engaged in design and installation - 200+ app submissions from residents - 1,000+ community votes - Professional before/after photography for each panel

Outcomes (what will change): - Reduced tripping hazards in the pilot neighborhood - Increased youth civic engagement and public art skills - Stronger neighborhood identity and pride - Measurable community participation in civic decision-making

Evaluation Methods: - **Pre/post panel assessment:** Photo documentation and hazard rating for each panel - **Youth surveys:** Confidence in civic participation, art skills, neighborhood connection - **Community metrics:** App

submissions, votes, event attendance - **Financial tracking:** Revenue vs. expenses by category, cost per panel

Reporting: - Quarterly progress reports to all funders - Annual impact report with outcomes, photos, and financials - Public dashboard on website showing panels completed, youth engaged, and votes cast

Section 7: Organizational Capacity (1 page)

Leadership: - Trevor Damyan, Founder and Board President: [background relevant to project management, community engagement, or nonprofit formation] - Jason Clement, Founding Tech Partner: Built the mobile app powering resident submissions and voting - Teaching Artist: [name TBD, experienced in public mosaic art and youth education]

Partners: - Licensed concrete crews with city permit experience - The Pottery Room, Culver City (potential teaching artist network) - Mid-City West Neighborhood Council (potential local improvement funding)

Governance: - Board of Directors: minimum 3 directors per California nonprofit requirements - Conflict of Interest Policy: included in bylaws - Fiscal oversight: monthly bookkeeping; annual review

Section 8: Sustainability (1 page)

Year 2 Scaling: - Expand to 30 panels across 3 neighborhoods - Revenue grows to approximately \$95,000 through larger grants and expanded sponsorships - Program reaches break-even or slightly positive

Year 3 and Beyond: - Expand to 60+ panels annually - Diversified funding base: grants, sponsors, recurring donations - Program becomes self-sustaining with track record and portfolio of completed mosaics

Diversified Revenue Strategy: - Grant funding (community arts, youth development, public safety) - Corporate sponsorships (\$750 per panel) - Individual donations (monthly giving program) - Neighborhood Council grants - Potential fiscal sponsorship in Year 1 to reduce overhead

Section 9: Attachments Checklist

- [] 501(c)(3) determination letter (or fiscal sponsor letter if applicable)

- [] Board of Directors list with bios
 - [] One-Page Funder Prospectus
 - [] Financial Model (Pilot Scenario)
 - [] Budget detail with narrative
 - [] Letters of support from community partners
 - [] Photos of pilot neighborhood sidewalk conditions
 - [] Teaching artist resume or portfolio
 - [] Proof of general liability insurance (or commitment to obtain)
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Notes for Adaptation

For arts funders: Emphasize the public art outcome, teaching artist credentials, and youth creative development.

For public safety funders: Emphasize the hazard removal, senior safety, and accessibility improvements.

For youth development funders: Emphasize the hands-on learning, civic engagement, and skill building for neighborhood kids.

For neighborhood improvement funders: Emphasize the community voting process, local business sponsorships, and visible neighborhood transformation.